



Snapdragon X2 Elite raises the bar for PCs

On gaming and AI, according to Qualcomm's **Kedar Kondap**

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Qualcomm is sharpening its focus on high-performance computing. At the recently concluded Snapdragon Summit 2025, I got a chance to sit with Kedar Kondap, Senior Vice President and GM of Qualcomm's Compute division to understand the company's ambitions in the PC market and various aspects of the new chip.

Gaming was a headline feature of the keynote, with Qualcomm signaling its intent to bring the same dominance it enjoys in smartphones to the world of PCs. Kondap called gaming "a category that excites almost everybody" and noted that Qualcomm's long-standing partnerships with game developers and engine makers are being extended to Windows devices.

Qualcomm has also worked to ensure compatibility with AAA titles, addressing lingering challenges such as support for Epic Games' Easy Anti-Cheat, a critical feature for online multiplayer titles. "That was huge progress for us," Kondap said.

The company also confirmed that Fortnite is coming to Snapdragon-powered PCs, alongside new titles like Alien Rogue Inversion from Servios. It's even bringing an on-device AI experience in Alien: Rogue Incursion Evolved Edition using the X2 Elite's NPU. These might be the first serious steps from Qualcomm on Windows gaming.

Pushing the boundaries of performance and efficiency

While gaming grabbed attention, Qualcomm's broader ambition is to redefine the performance and efficiency equation for laptops. Kondap explained that the first-generation Snapdragon X Elite prioritised three pillars: performance, battery life and AI. He said that the new X2 Elite will raise the bar across all three. Powered by the third-generation Oryon CPU,



the platform delivers 30–50 per cent CPU performance gains and up to 60 per cent improvements in performance-per-watt compared to the previous generation. Kondap described these jumps as "pretty much unprecedented" in the PC industry.

Battery efficiency, a hallmark of Snapdragon-powered laptops, remains central to Qualcomm's pitch. The company has already demonstrated what is possible with devices like the HP Omnibook 5, which boasts up to

34 hours of battery life. With the X2 Elite, Qualcomm aims to sustain and expand this advantage over traditional x86-based competitors.

The Snapdragon X2 Elite also represents a dramatic leap in AI capability. The platform integrates a new NPU (Neural Processing Unit) that delivers 80 TOPS (trillions of operations per second), as the industry shifts toward agentic AI models and always-on intelligent experiences. "We see the market moving towards Agentic AI, and we see the need for more TOPS," Kondap emphasised, framing AI as the defining battleground for the next wave of PC innovation.

The market strategy

Unlike last year, when Qualcomm announced laptops almost immediately after unveiling the first Snapdragon X Elite, the company now expects the first wave of X2 Elite-powered laptops to launch in spring 2026. According to Kondap, rollout timelines depend on individual OEM strategies, but he is encouraging partners to ensure global and Indian availability.

With the Snapdragon X2 Elite, Qualcomm is making an aggressive play to shape the future of Windows PCs, betting that its legacy in mobile computing can translate into leadership in a market long dominated by Intel and AMD. 